

Documentation Dataset Plantations Surinaamse Almanakken version 2.0

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The dataset 'Plantations Surinaamse Almanakken v2.0.csv' is an improved version of v1.0 and is based on list of plantations published in the *Surinaamsche Almanak* (1818-1847) and the *Almanak voor de Nederlandsche West-Indische bezittingen, en de kust van Guinea* (1856-1861). New editions of the almanacks were published for most years between 1818 and 1861, containing wide-ranging information about the then Dutch colony or Suriname, including a detailed list of plantations.¹ The almanacs are available online at dbnl.org (National Library of the Netherlands) as scans and ocr'ed text.² The plantation tables published in each of these editions form the basis for the dataset.

The ocr'ed information from the Almanacs was transcribed and imported into one spreadsheet per annual edition by student assistant Doortje Swaters as part of the Historical Database of Suriname and the Caribbean (HDSC) project at Radboud University. The ocr'ed data was corrected and cleaned by Evi Smits during an internship at the HDSC team. In the next phase, the separate spreadsheets have been merged into a single spreadsheet by Nico Altink and Thunnis van Oort. They have continued to clean and standardize the data, using Open Refine. They received support from student assistant Damian Pikulić.

Each edition of the Almanac contained a list of plantations in Suriname and some other locations such as military posts. The plantations were organized per river or creek, and in some cases per road. Per plantation, at least the name of the plantation is listed, and usually the produce, owner, administrator, and plantation manager. In later editions, information was added about the number of enslaved and free persons living on the plantation, the size of the plot, the type of mill and the district or division in which the plantation was located. Especially the information on enslaved and free workers became more elaborate in the 1850s.

The dataset includes references to www.wikidata.org. The wikidata identifier (Q-id) functions as the unique identifier of a plantation.

In the period covered by the Almanaks, plantations would regularly merge into larger units or split into smaller parts. E.g. the plantations "Waterland" (Q59134059) and "Adrichem" (Q124812970) on the Suriname river merged into the combined "Waterland en Adrichem" (Q59134062) during the years 1828-1831 and after those years continued as separate plantations. When a plantation was merged or split, the dataset contains both the singular `plantation_id` and the id of the composite plantation it was part of ('`part_of_id`'); or the other way around, the singular ids ('`has_parts_id`' 1 to 4) of which a merged plantation was composed.

Plantations in the dataset have been linked to plantations that occur in another dataset: the Suriname Plantation Dataset from the Suriname Slave registers.³ This second dataset contains all

¹Fred. Oudschans Dentz, 'Surinaamsche Almanakken', *De West-Indische Gids*, 28 (1947), 175-176. See also Carl Haarnack, *Surinaamsche Almanak voor het jaar 1832*. Departement Paramaribo der Maatschappij Tot Nut van 't Algemeen. Amsterdam: C.G. Sulpke, 1831, Bukubooks blog, <https://bukubooks.wordpress.com/2014/12/07/almanak1832/> [consulted 18-12-2024]

²Surinaamsche Almanak: https://www.dbnl.org/tekst/sur001suri01_01/ and Almanak voor de Nederlandsche West-Indische Bezittingen: https://www.dbnl.org/tekst/alm009alma00_01/

³ Rosenbaum-Feldbrügge, Matthias; van Galen, Coen; Swaters, Doortje, 2023, "Suriname Plantation Dataset Version 1.0", <https://hdl.handle.net/10622/VTL43W>, IISH Data Collection, V1, UNF:6:by8B0cpjp8fexFugrZZ34A== [fileUNF]

the plantations (identified with the 'psur_id') that were legal entities that owned enslaved persons.

What is new in version 2?

Version 1.0 of the dataset contained numerous errors, both transcription mistakes and other data errors, for example plantations that were incorrectly disambiguated – especially plantations at different locations carrying the same name. Thunnis van Oort and Rick Mourits have cleaned the data through multiple iterations of correction rounds, checking for duplications, missing years and other chronological discontinuities, and unusual patterns in crop type or surface area of plantations. This has resulted in a multitude of corrections in the new version.

Entries were changed, de-duplicated, removed, or added. Version 1 counted 1,172 entries (unique plantations/locations); version 2 has 1,110, of which 972 return in version 2 with the same identifier and name; 93 have received corrections to the name; 6 plantations received a new identifier; 101 plantations were removed, and 39 plantations were added. And many values have been corrected, such as plantation product, size, etcetera.

The following table contains a brief explanation of all the columns in the dataset. Please note that the columns after 'lot', in particular the information about owners, administrators and managers, contain unprocessed transcription data: the information in these columns has not been cleaned or standardized and can still contain errors and should be used with caution. In a future version 3 of the dataset, we plan to further enhance the data these columns, especially on persons and legal entities that owned or managed plantations.

Field name v2.0	Explanation	Orig. field name (v1.0)
recordid	Unique record id based on year-page-id row number	
id	Row number of the original tabel on a specific page of the almanac	
year	Almanac edition, that would reflect information of the previous year	
page	Page number in the original source	
litt_std	Letter that designates the district or division (standardized but not complete)	
district_of_divisie	Name of administrative district (not complete)	
loc_org	Original location description (region/district)	
loc_std	Location, standardized (region/district)	
river_or_road	Aggregated region based on main river or road	[NEW in v2.0]
direction	Direction of the plantation in relation to the road or river (left/right and up or down the river or road)	

plantation_std	Standardized name of the plantation	
plantation_org	Original plantation name	
plantation_id	Unique id for plantation, also referring to the wikidata.org page (https://www.wikidata.org/wiki/[place id here])	
psur_id	ID of the same plantation in the Suriname Plantation Dataset from the Suriname Slave registers	
psur_id2	Alternative ID of the same plantation in the Suriname Plantation Dataset from the Suriname Slave registers	[NEW in v2.0]
has_parts1_lab	Plantation name of the individual plantation that is part of a composite plantation in this row	split1_lab
has_parts1_id	Plantation id of the individual plantation that is part of a composite plantation in this row	split1_id
has_parts2_lab	Plantation name of the individual plantation that is part of a composite plantation in this row	split2_lab
has_parts2_id	Plantation id of the individual plantation that is part of a composite plantation in this row	split2_id
has_parts3_lab	Plantation name of the individual plantation that is part of a composite plantation in this row	split3_lab
has_parts3_id	Plantation id of the individual plantation that is part of a composite plantation in this row	split3_id
has_parts4_lab	Plantation name of the individual plantation that is part of a composite plantation in this row	split4_lab
has_parts4_id	Plantation id of the individual plantation that is part of a composite plantation in this row	split4_id
part_of_lab	Plantation name of the composite plantation listed in this row (plantation_id)	partof_lab
part_of_id	Plantation id of the composite plantation listed in this row (plantation_id)	part of_id
reference_org	Original reference to another plantation, that is the legal entity that owns the plantation in this row	
owned_by_lab	Reference to plantation (standardized name), that is the legal entity that owns the plantation in this row	reference_std_lab
owned_by_id	Reference to plantation id that is the legal entity that owns the plantation in this row	reference_std_id

owned_by_id2	Reference to a second plantation id that is the legal entity that owns the plantation in this row	[NEW in v2.0]
size_std	Size of the land area in acres ('akker'), standardized	
product_std	Produce cultivated at the plantation, standardized	
enslaved_norm	Total number of enslaved on this plantation (normalized integer that includes the sum of all relevant columns)	[NEW in v2.0]
enslaved_shared_with	In case the Almanak indicates that the stated number of enslaved people is shared with another plantation, the ID of that plantation is given here	[NEW in v2.0]
function	For some locations a specific function was mentioned, such as military or medical post	
additional_info	Additional information (in Dutch), not standardized	
deserted	Denotes when a plantation has been deserted ('verlaten')	
lot	Code designating original plot number or other identifier from original source (data not yet cleaned)	nummer
administrateurs	Administrator for the absentee owners	
directeuren	Plantation manager	
eigenaren	Owner	
administrateurs_in_Europa	Administrator in Europe, for the absentee owners	
administrateurs_in_suriname	Administrator in Suriname, for the absentee owners	
blank-officier	Overseer	
slaven	Number of enslaved persons (original transcription, see column 'enslaved_norm' for normalized totals).	
sranantongo_naam	Name the plantation was known by among the enslaved population	namen_totslaafgemaakten
plantage_mannelijke_niet_vrije_bewoners	Number of male enslaved inhabitants owned by plantation	
plantage_totaal_niet_vrije_bewoners	Total number of enslaved inhabitants owned by plantation	
plantage_vrouwelijke_niet_vrije_bewoners	Number of female enslaved inhabitants owned by plantation	
privé_mannelijke_niet_vrije_bewoners	Number of male enslaved inhabitants owned by private person	
privé_totaal_niet_vrije_bewoners	Total number of enslaved inhabitants owned by private person	

privé_vrouwelijke_niet_vrije_bewoners	Number of female enslaved inhabitants owned by private person	
soort_van_molen	Type of mill	
totaal_generaal_bewoners	Total number of inhabitants	
vrije_bewoners	Total number of free inhabitants	
generaal_totaal_slaven	Total number of enslaved inhabitants	
generale_macht_slaven_geschikt_tot_werken_plantages	Number of enslaved inhabitants owned by plantation fit for labour	
generale_macht_slaven_geschikt_tot_werken_privé	Number of enslaved inhabitants owned by private person fit for labour	
generale_macht_slaven_ongeschikt_tot_werken_plantages	Number of enslaved inhabitants owned by plantation unfit for labour	
generale_macht_slaven_ongeschikt_tot_werken_privé	Number of enslaved inhabitants owned by private person unfit for labour	
totaal_slaven_op_de_plantages_aanwezig_geschied_tot_werk	Total number of enslaved inhabitants fit for labour	
totaal_slaven_op_de_plantages_aanwezig_ongeschied_tot_werk	Total number of enslaved inhabitants unfit for labour	
vrije_persoonen_op_plantagesjongens	Free inhabitants (boys)	
vrije_persoonen_op_plantagesmannen	Free inhabitants (adult men)	
vrije_persoonen_op_plantagesmeisjes	Free inhabitants (girls)	
vrije_persoonen_op_plantagesvrouwen	Free inhabitants (adult women)	
vrije_persoonen_op_plantages_totaal	Free inhabitants (total)	
werktuig_stoom	Steam engine	
werktuig_water	Water engine	

The table below contains a brief explanation of some of the Dutch words that occur in the dataset.

Dutch term	Explanation
Aan	belongs to (in column 'eigenaren')
Administrateur	administrator for the absentee owners
Afvaren	downstream
Beide	both

Blankofficier	litt: white overseer, free overseer
Brandhout	fire wood
Chirurgisch etablissement	medical post
Cacao	cocoa
Directeur	manager of a plantation
Eigenaar	owner
Grond	piece of land
Heelmeester	medical doctor
Hout	wood
Katoen	cotton
Kerk	church
Koffie	coffee
Kollegietuin	experimental garden (proeftuin)
Kost	food (for enslaved plantation workers)
Kweek	seedling nursery
Links	left
Litt.	Letter
Militaire post	military post
Oevers	banks of a river or creek
Onbekend	Unknown
Opvaren	upstream
Pad	road
Rechts	right
Rijst	rice
Rijweg	road
Steen	stone quarry
Stoom	steam engine
Suiker	sugar
Verlaten	deserted
Waterwerk	water mill
Weg	road
Weggespoeld	flooded
Zeekust	sea coast
Zie	'see' – plantation belongs to (in column 'eigenaren')